

SIMPLE SQUARES TOTE

This cheerful tote bag is perfect for popping to the shops, heading to the beach, or carrying your quilting supplies while you

are on the go. The bag is assembled using a simple, square patchwork pattern with no quilting needed.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Medium

SIZE

30 x 22.5 x 15cm (12 x 8¾ x 6in)

TOOLS AND MATERIALS

Measuring tape

Rotary cutter or scissors

Cutting mat (optional)

Quilter's ruler

Pins

Threads to match your fabrics

Sewing machine

Iron and ironing board

Sewing needle

One 3.5cm (1½in) button

FABRICS

A, B, C, D, E, F, G, H, I Assorted scraps of cotton fabric for the patchwork squares to make a total of 44 squares, each 9.5cm (3¾in)

J 50cm (20in) of 112cm (44in) wide cotton fabric for the lining

K 30cm (12in) of 112cm (44in) wide cotton fabric for the straps

L 14 x 18cm (5½ x 7in) cotton fabric for the button flap

SKILLS

Piecing (see pp.58–60)

Sewing intersecting seams (see pp.62–63)

SEAM ALLOWANCE

1cm (¾in) throughout, unless otherwise stated

PATTERN

FRONT AND BACK OF BAG (CUT TWO BATCHES OF 18 SQUARES)

A	B	C	D	E	G	Top row
C	H	I	F	A	H	Middle row
E	F	D	H	G	I	Bottom row

BASE OF BAG (CUT ONE BATCH OF 8 SQUARES)

A	E	B	D
H	F	I	G

Cut the patchwork squares using the diagrams as a guide to how many squares of each fabric are needed and how to lay them out. Remember to cut squares for both the front and back of the bag. You only need to cut one batch of squares for the base of the bag.



1 Following the diagrams above, cut a total of 44 squares of fabric, each 9.5cm (3¾in) square. With right sides together, stitch together the squares for the top and middle rows of the front and back of the bag making four strips of six squares each.



2 With right sides together, stitch together the squares for the bottom row of the front and the bottom row of the back of the bag. Mark with a pin 1cm (¾in) from the lower edge of the first and last squares in each row and take care not to sew beyond the pins.